prove. And what harm could there be in her delivering the report for one night? If she felt unsure, then she could stop. “Assess him tonight. If you feel too uncomfortable, you don’t have to continue,” Léa said.

The church bell rang six times. Rose needed to go so that she would have enough time to return to the barracks before dinner. After gathering up the pages of the report, Léa put them in a gray folder and handed them to her sister.

“The Gestapo office is on the other side of the church,” Josef said. “The white building with a saddle roof. Third floor. Say as little as possible. The more you speak, the greater the chance he has of catching you in a lie.”

Rose nodded. “OK.”

“Good luck and be careful,” Léa said.

After Rose left, Josef sat down. “I never liked Reinhardt. He used to come here, asking questions about the patients as if he didn’t believe they were ill. And he threatened the sick with accusations of sabotage if they didn’t return to work. After he sent a few back to the factory and they died, he left me alone.” He rubbed his hands, chapped from the dry air and constant washing. “He’s a wolf.”

“We’re living in the time of the wolves.”

“That’s why Rose should keep her head down, wait for this horrible war to end.”

If everyone did that, then where would they be? She’d already seen that behavior in France. “I don’t think she has that option,” she said, as Josef approached her. “Rose may have some power when she meets him again. He hasn’t seen her for four months but he’s been sending her gifts, trying to draw her to him.” She looked away. “And Rose has other reasons for doing this. We’re not like you.”

“What does that mean?” he asked gently.

She sucked in air. “France is an ally of Germany. We weren’t rounded up, we came here willingly.”

“I don’t believe that.”

“It’s true.”

“I mean, no one ends up in this old mining town on the edge of Germany working ten-hour days because they *want* to be here. War is a massive uncontrollable wave, sweeping up all life in its wake. Don’t blame yourself.” He took a breath. “In Prague, when the Germans first annexed